

Checking Steps



The Eight-Step Translation Method

Drafting Steps

- Consume
- Verbalize
- Chunk
- Blind Draft



Checking Steps

- Self-edit
- Peer-edit
- Key Word Check
- Verse-by-Verse Check





Alone

Step 5: Self-Edit



No
time limit

Each one should examine his own work... Galatians 6:4a

Process: 1. Compare your draft to the source text
2. Make any needed changes

Benefits: • Any missing, added, or incorrect information can be corrected
• You retain ownership and responsibility for your draft

Tip: Use your Quality Assessment Guide to make sure your draft meets every quality you desire in your translation.
Use as many resources as you have available.



With a partner

Step 6: Peer-Check

No
time limit



Two people work better than one; together they can earn a good wage for their labor.
Ecclesiastes 4:9

- Process:
1. A partner compares your draft to the source text
 2. The partner asks questions and suggests edits
 3. Discuss changes, asking others for input if needed
 4. Make the changes you agree on

- Benefits:
- Others often catch mistakes you miss
 - A partner can tell if your translation is easy to understand
 - You retain ownership and responsibility for your draft

- Tips:
- Make sure to read the translation out loud.
 - Use all resources available.
 - Check that the meaning is clearly communicated.



With a new partner

Step 7: Key Word Check



No
time limit

But the one to whom I have declared something, let him declare my word truthfully.

Jeremiah 23:28b

- Process:
1. A partner marks all the key words and key terms in the source text
 2. Check that every one of these words is in the draft
 3. Check that the definitions of these words in the draft communicate the same meaning as the definitions of the words in the source text.

- Benefits:
- Ensures meaning-based translation
 - Begins the process of consistency checking
 - Verifies theological accuracy
 - Helps teams find the best way to convey spiritual concepts
 - Improves clarity and accuracy

Tips: The translation may need to use more than one word to express the same meaning as a key word or a key term.
Keep a list of the words that are difficult to express in your language for your whole team to use. Include the translations you chose for each word.



With two new partners

Step 8: Verse-by-Verse Check



No
time limit

Iron sharpens iron; in the same way, a man sharpens his friend. Proverbs 27:17

- Process:
1. Read the translation aloud
 2. One partner orally translates it back into the source language
 3. The second partner compares the oral back-translation to the source text
 4. The three discuss differences and make corrections

- Benefits:
- New readers/listeners may notice small problems that others missed
 - Accuracy and meaning are more closely examined
 - Flow, clarity, and naturalness are all affirmed

Checking Steps Summarized

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Self-edit

Compare each chunk to source; make any edits

6

Peer-edit

Another translator compares and suggests edits

7

Key Word Check

Work with a partner to ensure that the key words are clear

8

Verse-by-Verse Check

- Translator reads each verse of translation aloud
- Checker 1, out loud, translates each verse back into the source language
- Checker 2 listens and looks at source text to compare





The checking steps
have no time limit ...



a **great time** for
discussion and research to
improve the text

Make changes
as needed ...



... praying for
God's guidance

Try it

Check the work
translated in last
session



Were there
many errors?



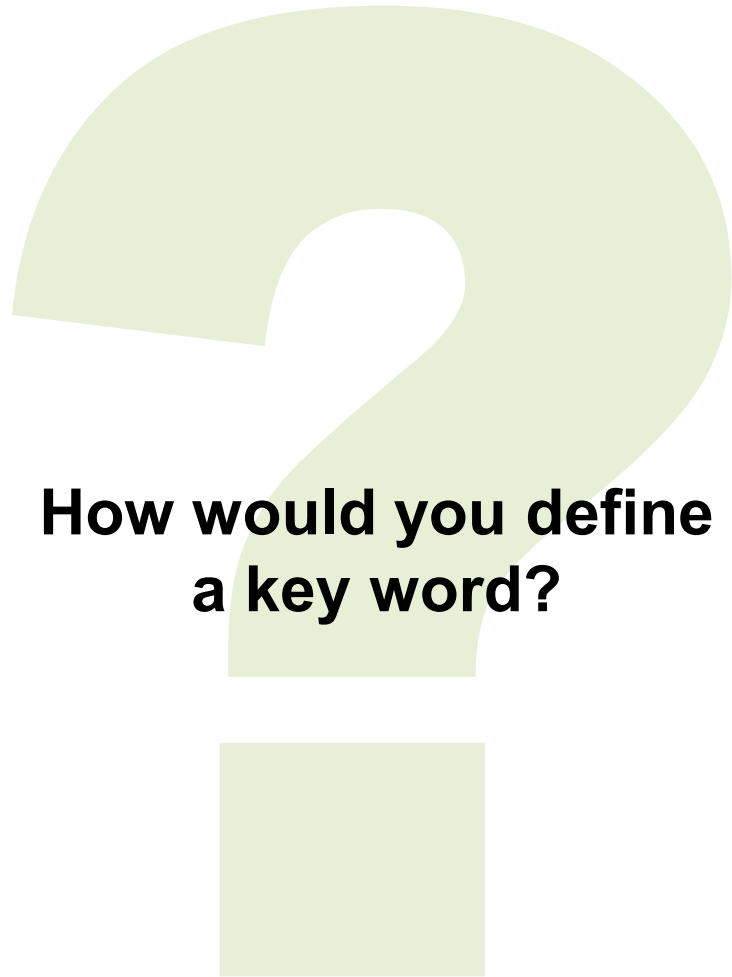
Did the checking
steps improve
the text?



**What happens if you
skip steps?**

Checking Step 7: Key Words





**How would you define
a key word?**

A strong impact on meaning

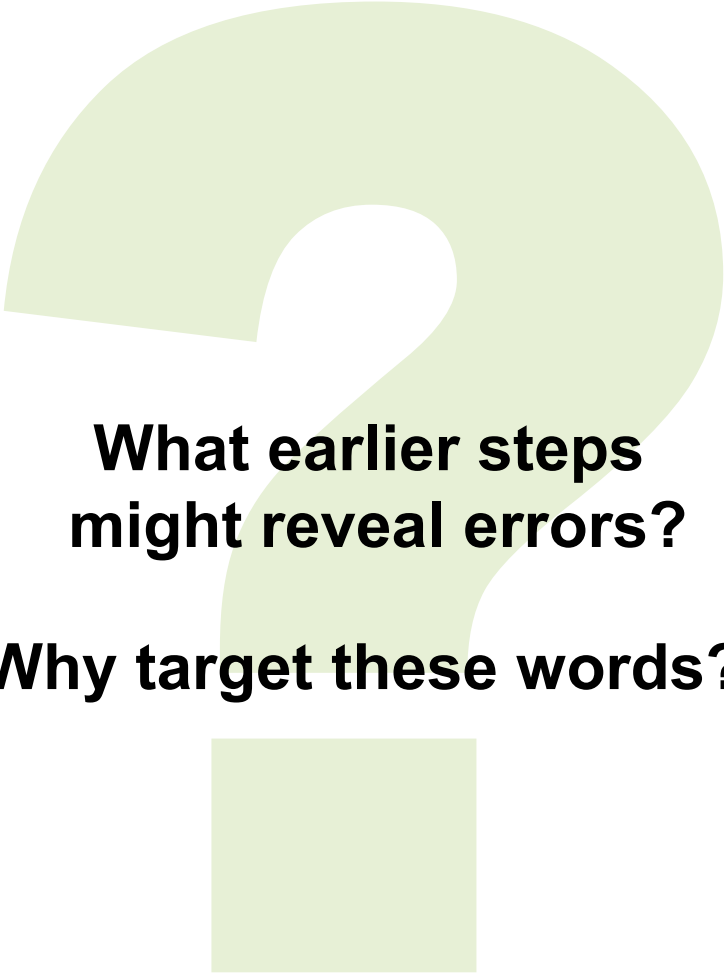


**Abstract
words**



**Spiritual
terms**

Often repeated for emphasis



**What earlier steps
might reveal errors?**

Why target these words?

**Often hard to
translate**

**Often
no precise
equivalent**

For God so loved the world, that he gave
his only Son, that whoever believes in
him will not perish but have eternal life.

John 3:16 (ULB)

For God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whoever believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.

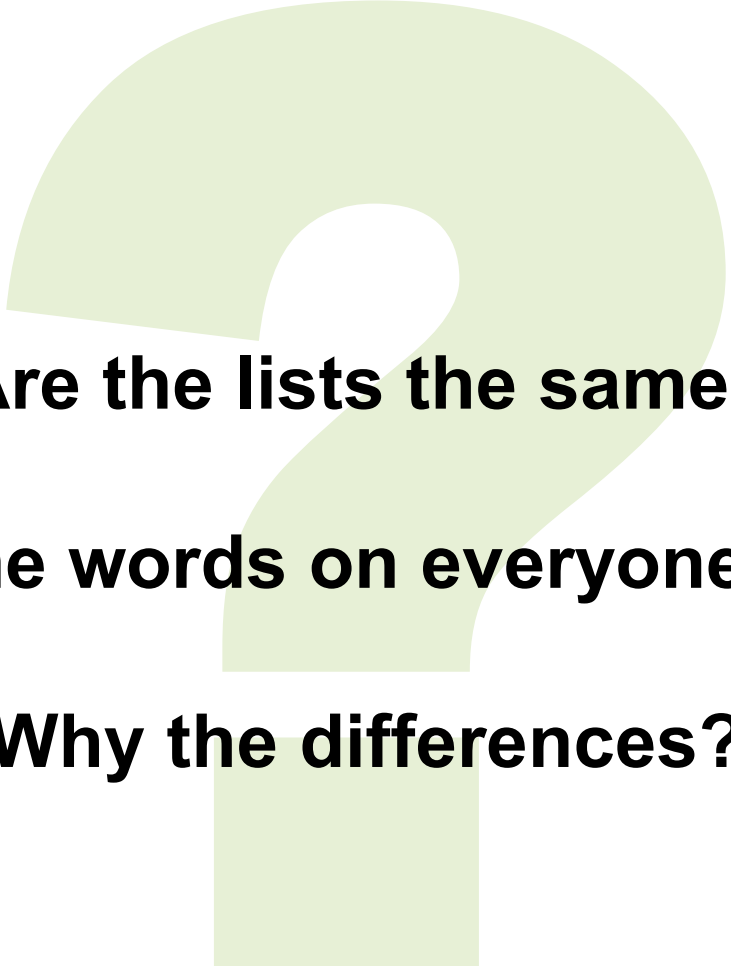
John 3:16 (ULB)



Try it

Luke 17

Discuss



Are the lists the same?

Are some words on everyone's lists?

Why the differences?

What to do with the key word list

- 1. Check translation for each key word.**
- 2. Discuss difficult words and choose how to translate.**
- 3. Create list to be used by all translators.**



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